

TIMOTHY NGALANDE

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EDUCATION

Stellenbosch University

2015-2018, 2021 - Present

Economics, Ph.D. – Mar, 2026

Master of commerce (Mcom) Economics – Mar 2019

Bachelor of commerce (Bcom-Hons) Economics – Mar 2017

University of Warwick

2018-2020

Master of Research (MRes) Economics – Sep 2020

University of Zurich

Study Abroad, Winter 2018

Master of Arts (MA) Economics- Data Science – June 2018

University of Malawi

2008-2012

Bachelor of Social science (Bsoc) Economics – Aug 2012

INTERESTS

Behavioral Research Growth/Development Economics Economic History Labour
Applied Macro/Micro

EXPERIENCE

Mobalyz (formerly SA Taxi)

2025 –

Research Manager

- Embedded research manager for a collaborative field research programme with faculty from Duke's Fuqua School of Business (Prof. Chris Eaglin), Dartmouth College (Profs. Jonathan Zinman & Apoorv Gupta), and Northwestern's Kellogg School of Management (Prof. Filippo Mezzanotti).
- Design and implement randomised controlled trials examining how loan restructuring, driving behavioural incentives, and shock-smoothing mechanisms shape firm performance among South Africa's 250,000+ minibus taxi operators.
- Manage data collection, experiment logistics, and research coordination between the academic team and Mobalyz operations staff.

Australia National University

2024-2025

Research Assistant

- With Prof Marine Mariotti : Digitising about 9000 archive images of government statistical and annual reports.

University of Warwick

2019- 2020

Research Assistant

- With Prof Dennis Novy : Literature review and data construction for a project on climate change and Trade.
- With Prof James Fenske : Data cleaning and analysis for a project on Genetics and culture.

Stellenbosch University

2017 - 2024

Research Assistant

- With Prof Johan Fourie and Prof Willem Boshof : Data consolidation, estimation and analysis for a project on [The evolution of the South African Economy](#)
- With Prof Johan Fourie : Analysis of collaboration networks in Economic History publications. Presented at the 7th African Economic History Network conference

Graduate Teaching Assistant

- Microeconomics, Game Theory (2022, 2024), Math for Economists (2017, 2022, 2023), Economic History (2018, 2022), Stata for Econometrics (2017), International Trade; undergrad course (2017)

Equip Consulting

2017 - 2024

Part Time Research Analysis and Program Evaluation

- Research Design, planning, analysis and visualisation of quantitative results. Also included programme evaluation

Airtel Mobile Commerce

2014-2015, 2020-2021

Usage, retention and Acquisition Manager

2020

- Analysing, monitoring and implementing targeted initiatives for growth of customer base and usage of Mobile Money services. Grew active users by about 1 Million

Business Analyst

2014

- Analysis and management advisory of all business functions for growth, compliance and profitability. Grew business to break-even profitability.

National Bank of Malawi

2010-2014

Savings Consultant

2013

- Account opening and long term savings asset creation and liquidation

Intern

December 2010, May 2011, December 2011

- Bank clerical work

DATA ANALYTICS SKILLS

Programming Languages

STATA, R, Python, SQL, MATLAB

Software & Tools

HTML, LaTeX, Excel, Mathematica, Git, Markdown

AWARDS AND RECOGNITIONS

Scholarship for Masters of Research Economics at the University of Warwick

2018

Three Merit Bursaries from Stellenbosch University's Economics department

2016, 2017, 2018

Represented Stellenbosch University at the world econometric games, Amsterdam, ND

2017

Member of "KU Leuven - Stellenbosch University Think Tank" Belgium

2017

RESEARCH

Geographical Segregation, Misallocation and Productivity in Apartheid South Africa Manufacturing

PhD thesis chapter

- Quasi-experimental design using railway network upgrades as an instrument. Finds that state-led rail improvements causally increased manufacturing productivity through enhanced allocative efficiency, despite being designed to enforce spatial segregation.

Quantifying Apartness: A General Equilibrium Estimation of the Cost of Labour Discrimination in South Africa

PhD thesis chapter

- Calibrates a static general equilibrium model to quantify aggregate losses from the job reservation system. Counterfactual analysis shows the entire productivity cost of discrimination operated through misallocation, not technical inefficiency.

Race-Biased Technological Progress and Growth in 20th Century Industrial South Africa

PhD thesis chapter

- Growth accounting analysis of mining and manufacturing. Finds manufacturing growth was driven by technologically biased progress, while mining relied on intensification of cheap unskilled labour.

REFERENCES

Johan Fourie
Stellenbosch University
Economics Department & LEAP
johanf@sun.ac.za

Chris Eaglin
Duke University (Fuqua)
Strategy Area
chris.eaglin@duke.edu

Martine Mariotti
Australian National University
College of Business & Economics
martine.mariotti@anu.edu.au